SETUP GUIDE · WINDOWS PC

Setting up *The Assistant*

Six short steps, and you only do it once. Each numbered line is one thing to do. Go in order.

BEFORE YOU START, YOU NEED

one

A Windows PC

Windows 10 or 11, with its updates done, and the internet on while you set up.

two

A Claude plan, Pro or higher

The Assistant runs on your own Claude account. The free plan doesn't include the part of Claude it lives in.

three

An external hard drive

Where your shoots are kept. If your photos live on your computer for now, it still works, and the Assistant will talk to you about it once.

four

The Assistant file

One file called **The-Assistant.zip**, from **[PLACE: to decide]**. It lands in Downloads, maybe shown as **The-Assistant** with a zipper on its picture. Leave it as it is: don't open it or choose Extract All.

The six steps

1. Add Python from the Microsoft Store
2. Install Claude on your PC
3. Make a folder for the Assistant
4. Add the Assistant to Claude
5. Let it work while you're away
6. Say hi

Stuck at any point? Send a screenshot of what you see to **[ADDRESS: to decide]**. (Windows key + Shift + S takes one; paste it into your email with Ctrl + V.)

This is the first Windows edition, and you're among the first to use the Assistant on a PC. The pictures are drawings, so your screen will look a little different. If a word doesn't match, send us a screenshot.

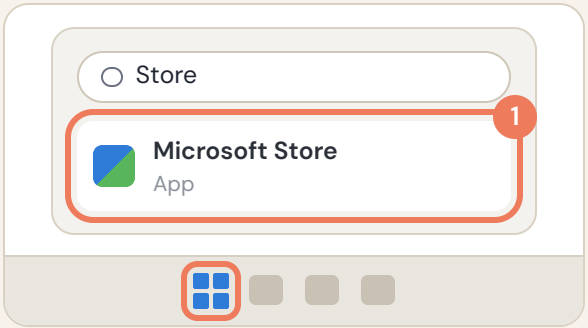
STEP 1 OF 6

1 Add Python from the Store

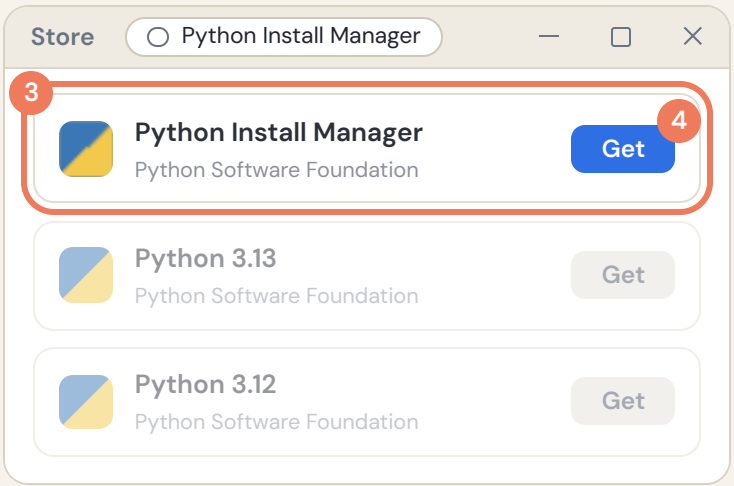
The Assistant runs on a small free piece of software called Python. A PC doesn't come with it, so you add it once. **Do this before you open Claude, so Claude finds it right away.**

Claude already open on this PC? Quit it first: right-click its icon by the clock, bottom right (click the small ^ if you don't see it), and choose **Quit**. The ✕ on its window may leave it running.

1. Click **Start**, the Windows logo at the bottom of your screen, and type **Store**. Click **Microsoft Store**.
2. In the search box at the top of the Store, type **Python Install Manager** and press **Enter**.
3. Click the one called **Python Install Manager**, from the Python Software Foundation. Not the ones called Python with a number after it (like Python 3.13).
4. Click **Get** (it may say Install). Wait until it's finished. **Then you're done: don't click Open.** There's nothing to open.



Drawing. Start is the Windows logo on the bar along the bottom of your screen.



Drawing. Pick Python Install Manager, the first one here, and leave the others.

You'll know it worked when the button where Get was says **Open**. Leave it and close the Store. Python finishes setting itself up the first time the Assistant uses it.

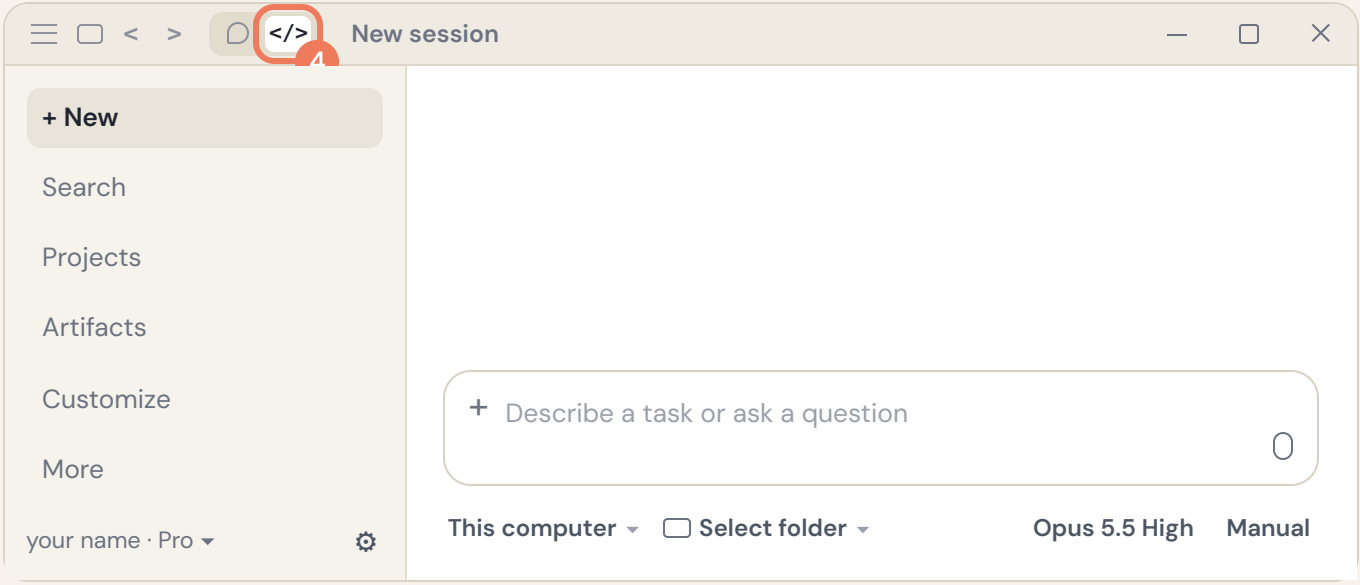
Clicked Open anyway? A black window asks a few questions. Press **Enter** at each one. When it stops asking, close it with the ✕ at its top right.

STEP 2 OF 6

2 Install Claude on your PC

Claude is the app the Assistant lives inside. **Already have Claude on this PC and you're signed in? Open it from the Start menu and start at number 4 on this page.**

1. Open your web browser (Edge is fine) and go to **claude.ai/download**.
2. Click the download for **Windows**. When it has downloaded, open the file. If Windows asks whether to let this app make changes to your device, click **Yes**.
3. Open **Claude** from the Start menu and **sign in** with your Claude account.
4. Look at the top left of the Claude window. There's a small box with two pictures in it: a speech bubble and **</>**. Click **</>**. (If you see the words Chat and Code instead, click Code.) That part of Claude is called **Code**. You won't write any code.



Drawing. The </> picture is at the top left. The three buttons at the top right (–, □, X) are Windows' own.

You'll know it worked when the top of the window says **New session** and there's a message box at the bottom with a few small choices under it. A small box in the middle about "Choose environment" or "Connect GitHub" can be ignored. You don't need GitHub.

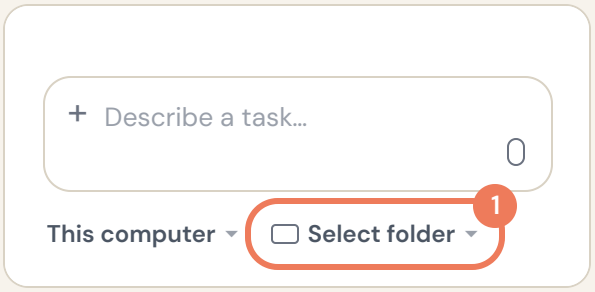
If Claude says your plan doesn't include this part, you need Pro or higher. **If it asks you to sign in online,** follow the link, then come back to the app. **If the download page offers two Windows versions,** take the plain one, unless your PC has an ARM chip (such as a Snapdragon): then take ARM64. Not sure? Click Start, type **About**, open **About your PC**, and look at **System type**.

STEP 3 OF 6

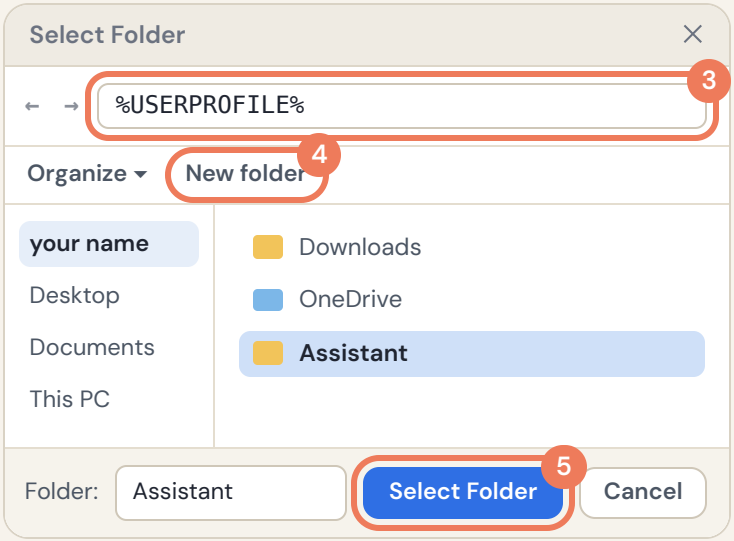
3 Make a folder for the Assistant

Claude needs a small folder to start in. This one is only for the Assistant's own use. **Your photos never go in this folder.**

1. Under the message box, click the choice with a small **folder** picture in front of it.
2. Click **Open folder…** A window opens showing your files.
3. Click in the long box at the very top of that window (the address bar). Type **%USERPROFILE%** and press **Enter**. That jumps to your **home folder**, the one with your name on it.
4. Click **New folder** near the top. Type **Assistant** and press **Enter**.
5. With the new **Assistant** folder selected, click **Select Folder**.



Drawing. The folder choice. It may say Select folder, or the name of a folder you've used before.



Drawing. Your home folder, with the new folder in it.

You'll know it worked when the folder choice under the message box now says **Assistant**.

Not in Documents, Desktop, Pictures or OneDrive. On many PCs Windows keeps the first three inside OneDrive, which copies everything to the cloud and can hold a file busy while it does. Your home folder isn't. (The file in Downloads is fine where it is.)

The address bar won't take it? Click **This PC** on the left, then **Local Disk (C:)**, **Users**, and the folder with your name. Carry on from number 4.

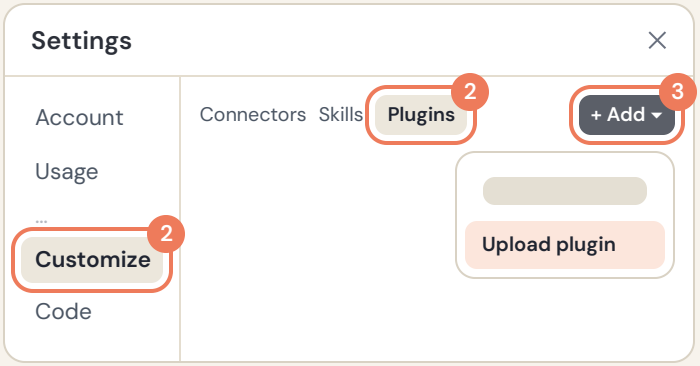
STEP 4 OF 6

4 Add the Assistant to Claude

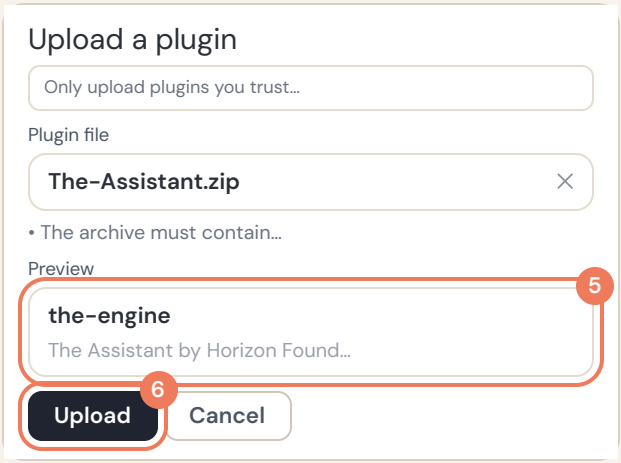
You add the Assistant from Claude's own **Settings**, using the file you downloaded. (Claude calls add-ons like the Assistant **plugins**.) **Nothing gets typed.**

Installed "The Engine" from us before? Message us at [ADDRESS: to decide] before you go on. Never had it? Carry on.

1. At the very bottom left, at the right end of the line with your name, click the small **gear**. A box called **Settings** opens.
2. Click **Customize** in the Settings list on the left, near the bottom (on newer copies it's called **Plugins**). If you see a row of words at the top, click **Plugins** there. (Landed on Connectors? Leave its buttons alone.)
3. Click the dark **+ Add** button at the far top right, then **Upload plugin** (not Add marketplace).
4. Under **Plugin file**, click to choose a file. In the window that opens, click **Downloads** on the left, click **The-Assistant** (the one with a zipper on its picture), then **Open**.
5. Check two things: **no line with a red !**, and the **Preview** says **the-engine**, "The Assistant by Horizon Found..." (the-engine is its behind-the-scenes name.)
6. Click the black **Upload** button (grey means the file isn't right), then close Settings with its **X**. The real proof is Step 6.



Drawing. Your + Add list may have more lines. Click the one about uploading a plugin.



Drawing. The two grey notes are always there. They are not errors.

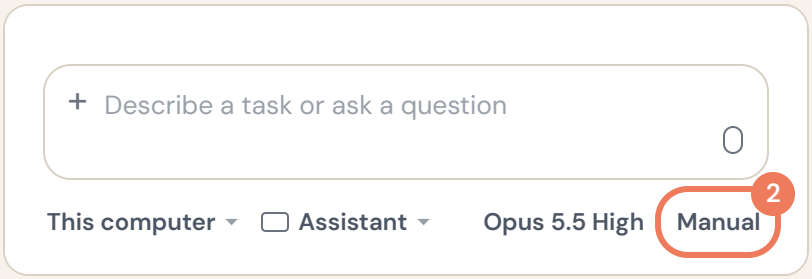
A red ! that says "Plugin failed validation"? Stop and send a screenshot to [ADDRESS: to decide]. That one is ours to fix. **"This marketplace is already added"?** Cancel, then + Add, Upload plugin. **"The Engine" with an Add button?** Leave it. It's an old copy.

STEP 5 OF 6

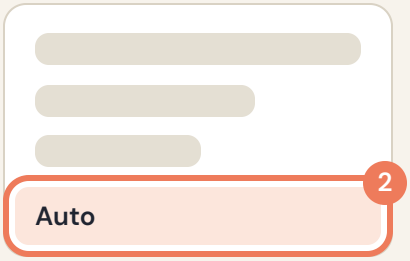
5 Let it work while you're away

This step lets a backup finish while you're out of the room. Without it, Claude may stop and ask your permission before each thing it does.

1. Look under the message box, at the right. After the name of the Claude you're using (ours said Opus 5.5), there is one word. If it says **Auto**, you're done with this step.
2. If it says anything else, click that word. In the list that opens, click **Auto**.



Drawing. The word is at the right, under the message box.



Drawing. Your list may have other words in it. Auto is the one to click.

You'll know it worked when that word says **Auto**. Glance at it each time you start; if it has changed, set it back.

Is this safe? Auto means Claude does the backup's steps without asking each time, with its own safety checks running. And the Assistant has one rule it never breaks, in any mode: **nothing on your memory card is ever deleted, moved or changed.**

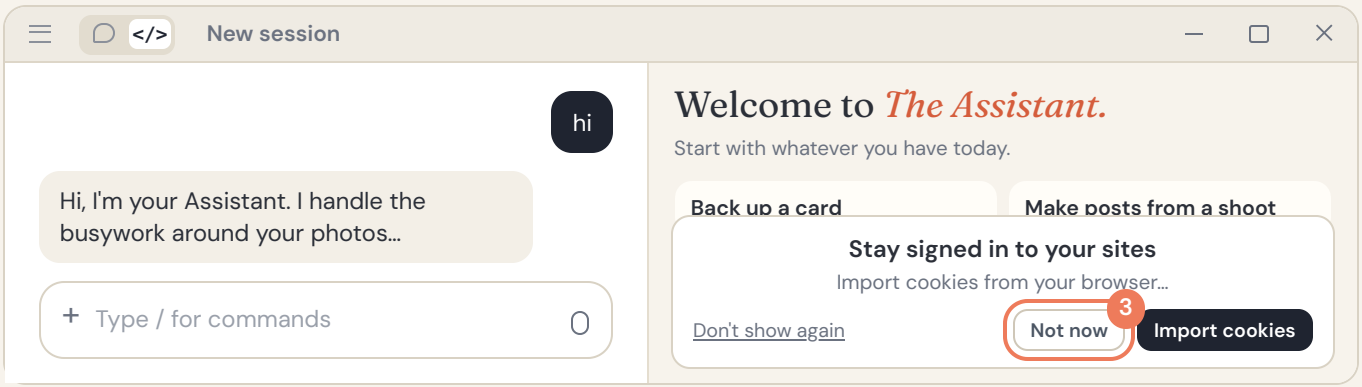
Don't see Auto in the list? Click the name just left of that word (ours said Opus 5.5), pick the newest one in the list, then look again. Still not there? Your Claude may need its update: click the **three lines** at the top left of the Claude window, then **Help**, then **Check for Updates**. Let it restart, then look again.

STEP 6 OF 6

6 Say hi

That's the setup. Now meet your Assistant.

1. Click inside the message box, type **hi** and press **Enter**.
2. Give it a few minutes the first time: Python finishes setting itself up now. Grey lines show in the chat ("Ran 2 commands"): nothing to click. Then it asks to add one more free piece, called Pillow, for showing your photos: click **Yes, add it**. Then it introduces itself, and its home page opens beside the chat.
3. Claude may offer to copy your browser's sign-ins ("Stay signed in to your sites"). Click **Not now** or **Don't show again**. Clicked Import cookies by mistake? Click **Cancel** in the next box.



Drawing. The chat on the left, the Assistant's home page on the right, and the pop-up to dismiss.

Things you might see

"Your PC needs one free piece from Microsoft"	Python isn't on yet. Do Step 1, quit Claude (right-click its icon near the clock, Quit), open it again from the Start menu, say **hi**. Still says it? Restart your PC and say hi again.
"It's called Pillow, and I can add it now"	At your first hi. Click **Yes, add it**: about a minute, once. Said Not now? It asks again the first time you make posts or back up a card.
A Windows Security box about Python and networks	Leave **Private networks** ticked and click **Allow access**. It's for the Assistant's own pages, which run on this PC only.
You said hi and no page opened beside the chat	Click **+ New** (top of the left column), check the folder under the message box says **Assistant**, say hi again. Still nothing? Screenshot to **[ADDRESS: to decide]**.

You're set up. Next time: open Claude from the Start menu, click **</>**, click **+ New**, check the folder under the message box says **Assistant**, type **hi**.

OPTIONAL · ANY TIME

A tap on your phone

The Assistant can tap you on your phone when a backup is done, or when it's waiting on an answer from you. Skip this page if you don't want that. You can come back to it later.

1. **Put Claude on your phone.** Get the Claude app from the App Store or Google Play and sign in with the **same** Claude account. When the phone asks whether Claude may send notifications, say **Allow**.

2. **Link your PC to your phone.** On your PC, open Claude's **Settings** (the gear, as in Step 4), click **Code** in its list (it may say Claude Code), and turn on **Connect new sessions to Remote Control**. Close Settings, then click **+ New**.

3. **Turn on the taps.** Click in the message box, type the first line below exactly as it is and press Enter. Then the second line, the same way. Each one answers with a line saying it's set to true.

FIRST LINE

```
/config agentPushNotifEnabled=true                    TYPE IT, THEN ENTER
```

SECOND LINE

```
/config inputNeededNotifEnabled=true                  TYPE IT, THEN ENTER
```

What each one does: the first lets the Assistant tap you when a backup finishes. The second taps you when it's waiting on an answer from you.

Good to know. Your PC has to be on and awake, with Claude open. The Assistant asks the PC to stay awake during a backup, but closing a laptop's lid still puts it to sleep: leave it open, with the charger in. And if you're sitting at the PC, the tap is skipped, since you can already see it on screen.

YOU'RE IN

Two good places to *start*

You don't need a memory card to begin. Talk to the Assistant in your own words.

Photos you've *already finished*

Edited and exported, sitting in a folder.

1. On the home page, click **Make posts from a shoot**. **The first time only,** the box says **set up my Assistant folder**: click **Copy**, click in the chat's message box, press Ctrl + V, then Enter, and answer its one question about where to keep your posts. The box then changes (if not, click Make posts again).
2. Click **Select the folder with your finished photos**. A small window with a list of folders opens: click the little arrows to open **This PC** and your drive, click the folder with your exports, then **OK**.
3. Click **Copy** next to **make my posts**, paste it in the chat with Ctrl + V, and press Enter.

You get a carousel (or a single post) and stories sized for Instagram, and a reel page where you pick the song and the pace, then finish the reel in CapCut (you'll need the CapCut app). The Assistant works from its own copies; your originals aren't moved or changed. **Reels in CapCut are new on a PC:** if yours doesn't show up in CapCut, tell the Assistant.

A *memory card* with new photos

Straight out of the camera.

1. Put the card in and plug in your drive. If Windows pops up a note asking what to do with the card, ignore it, or pick **Take no action**.
2. Type **backup now** in the chat and press Enter.
3. The first time, the Assistant asks a few setup questions, one at a time, with buttons. Your drives show with their letters, like **Big Kahuna (E:)**. After that, it's one quick screen each time.
4. When it says **You can walk away**, walk away. On a laptop, leave the lid open and the charger in.

When you're back, click **Show the report** in the chat. Every photo is copied and checked, sorted into named shoots, with six sneak peeks picked to edit first.

Why not drag the folder in? On a PC, dragging a folder into another folder on the same drive **moves** it rather than copying it, so the folder you dragged from ends up empty. Use the Select the folder button instead. Dragged one by mistake? Press **Ctrl + Z** in that File Explorer window right away and it comes back.

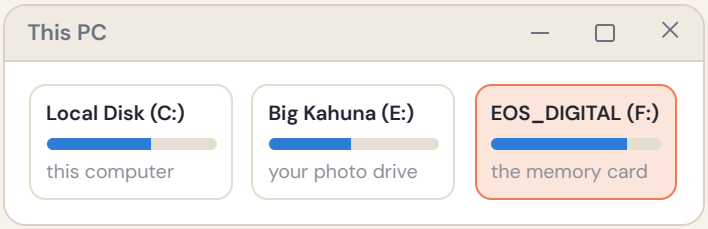
Rather say it than type it? Click in the message box, press the **Windows key + H**, and talk. That's Windows' own voice typing, and it needs the internet.

GOOD TO KNOW

How a PC is *different*

Drive letters

Windows gives each drive and memory card a letter when it's plugged in, and a drive doesn't always get the same letter. Some days the card even gets the letter your photo drive had. So before every backup the Assistant checks that your photo drive is where it should be, and that the card isn't. **If the letters have moved, it tells you and asks before it copies anything.**



Drawing. File Explorer's This PC. Your names and letters will differ.

Not on a PC yet

- **Looking through your videos for moments.** The reel page lists your videos and plays the usual kind (most cameras, or an iPhone set to Most Compatible), and you can pick a moment yourself with **Use this moment**. The Assistant can't pick moments for you yet.
- **iPhone videos in High Efficiency.** They can't play on the reel page on a PC yet. For your next shoot, set the iPhone to Most Compatible (Settings, Camera, Formats).
- **iPhone photos (HEIC).** Export them as JPEGs first, and the Assistant can use those.

If something isn't right

The page beside the chat is blank, or shows a play button	Don't press the play button. Type **show the Assistant** and the page comes back.
A folder button seemed to do nothing	The File Explorer window may be behind Claude. Click **File Explorer** on the taskbar at the bottom of your screen.
"Windows wouldn't let me move the folder"	A program has a photo in it open. Close Lightroom and any File Explorer window on that shoot, say **go**. Nothing is lost.
Claude keeps stopping to ask permission	Step 5 slipped back. Say yes to the one on screen, then set the word under the message box back to **Auto**.
A backup stopped	The Assistant says why, first thing. Fix that (plug the drive in, clear space) and say **backup now** again. Nothing is copied twice.
You're not sure what to do next	Say **hi**. It tells you where things stand and what you can say. We'll tell you when there's an update, and send the steps with it.

Three promises: nothing on your memory card is ever changed. Nothing is ever deleted. Nothing is ever posted or sent for you.